

Formal letter

What is a Formal Letter?

A formal letter is a written communication used for professional, official, or academic purposes. It follows a specific structure and uses a polite, respectful tone.

Structure of a Formal Letter:

1. **Sender's Address:**
 - Write your address at the top right corner.
 - Do not include your name here.
2. **Date:**
 - Write the date below your address (e.g., October 26, 2024).
3. **Recipient's Address:**
 - Write the recipient's address on the left, below the date.
4. **Salutation:**
 - Use a polite greeting (e.g., "Dear Mr. Smith," or "Dear Ms. Johnson,").
 - If you don't know the name, you can use "Dear Sir/Madam."
5. **Subject Line (Optional):**
 - A brief statement about the purpose of the letter (e.g., "Subject: Application for Summer Camp").
6. **Body of the Letter:**
 - **Introduction:** State the purpose of your letter in the first paragraph.
 - **Main Content:** Provide details, explanations, or arguments in the following paragraphs.
 - **Conclusion:** Summarize your points and state any action you expect or any request.
7. **Closing:**
 - Use a polite closing phrase (e.g., "Sincerely," "Yours faithfully,").
 - Leave a few lines for your signature.
8. **Signature:**
 - Sign your name above your typed name.
9. **Enclosures (if applicable):**
 - Mention any additional documents you are including with the letter (e.g., "Enclosure: Resume").

Tips for Writing a Formal Letter:

- **Use Formal Language:** Avoid slang and casual expressions. Be clear and concise.
- **Stay Professional:** Maintain a respectful tone throughout the letter.
- **Check Grammar and Spelling:** Proofread your letter for any errors before sending it.
- **Use Standard Formatting:** Keep margins even, and use a readable font (like Times New Roman or Arial, size 12).

Example of a Formal Letter:

[Your Address]

123 Main Street

Anytown, ST 12345

October 26, 2024

[Recipient's Address]

Mr. John Smith

456 Elm Street

Othertown, ST 67890

Dear Mr. Smith,

I am writing to express my interest in applying for the summer internship program at your company. I believe this opportunity will allow me to gain valuable experience in the field of marketing.

I am currently in the eighth grade and have developed a strong interest in marketing through my school projects and extracurricular activities. I am eager to learn more and contribute to your team.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the possibility of discussing this opportunity with you.

Sincerely,

[Your Signature]

Your Name

Enclosure: Resume

Practice:

1. **Write Your Own Formal Letter:** Choose a topic, such as applying for a school club or writing to a local authority.
2. **Peer Review:** Exchange letters with a classmate and provide feedback on structure and tone.
3. **Role-Playing:** Practice reading your letter aloud in front of the class or in small groups.